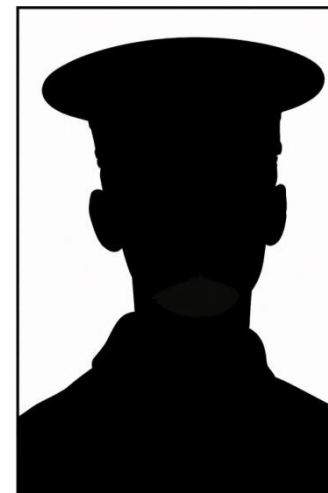




William David Densham

1894 – 1917

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	William David Densham	CWGC
Date of Birth	20/11/1894 Hull, Yorkshire	NatWest Bank Archives – see below 1911 census
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	23/4/1917	CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	22	CWGC
Marital Status	None recorded	
Children (if any)	none	
Occupation prior to Call up	National Provincial and Union Bank of England (same as father) see URL and details	https://www.natwestgroupmembers.com/our-fallen/our-fallen-ww1/d/william-densham.html

	below. Last place worked before signing up was the Strand Branch	
Parents	William and Jessie Margaret Densham, of Mount View, Bickington, Barnstaple	CWGC
Listed Address(s)	The Mount, Preston Road, nr Harrow on the Hill 2 Kenton Road, Harrow	1917 Red Cross document, see below 1911 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Manager of bank branch. National Provincial and Union Bank of England	1911 census NatWest Bank Archives – see below
Brothers and Sisters	None	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	I've yet to find one	
	I found his name and reg number listed in The Scotsman, 18/6/1917 as killed	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	National Provincial and Union Bank of England, Gibson Hall, Bishopsgate, London	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/552236
	John Lyon School, plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340969
***** incorrect spelling?	John Lyon School, sundial We believe the name recorded on the IWM online index is wrong – Densnam instead of Densham. Is that wrong on the memorial or on the IWM website? Someone should check and we can let IWM know. I believe this is him	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	National Provincial and Union Bank of England Sports Association Memorial Board currently at Group Archives, Edinburgh Originally at Beckenham Sports Ground	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/2091426

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	DENSHAM W.D.
CWGC Reference	Private William David Densham War Casualty Details 747193 CWGC
Age	22
DoD	23-Apr-17
Rank	Pte
Regiment	Gordon Highlanders 1st/7th Bn
	Buried at the Ecoivres Military Cemetery in Mont-St. Eloi, France (Grave Reference: VI. C. 20)
Location	ARRAS MEMORIAL - France
Military details	Son of William and Jessie Margaret Densham, of Mount View, Bickington, Barnstaple. Private William David Densham (Service Number S/40701) was killed in action on April 23, 1917 at the age of 22. He served with the 1st/7th Battalion of the Gordon Highlanders. He fell on the battlefields of Pas-de-Calais, France. He was killed on the first day of the Second Battle of the Scarpe (a major phase of the wider Battle of Arras). On this morning, the 51st (Highland) Division launched an attack against heavily fortified German positions along the chemical works and the village of Roeux, enduring massive machine-gun fire and artillery barrages. He is buried at the Ecoivres Military Cemetery in Mont-St. Eloi, France (Grave Reference: VI. C. 20). Born on November 20, 1894, he was the son of a bank worker. Before enlisting, he followed in his father's footsteps and worked for National Provincial Bank (now part of the NatWest Group). He is commemorated on the bank's corporate World War I Roll of Honour. According to NatWest Group archives, William David Densham was born on 20 November 1894, the son of William Densham, a bank worker, and his wife Jessie Margaret. By 1911, when Densham was 16 years old, his father was manager of National Provincial Bank of England's London High Holborn branch. In May that year, Densham also went to work for the bank, as apprentice at its London Marylebone branch. Densham completed his three-year apprenticeship in April 1914, and stayed on at Marylebone as a clerk. In May 1915 he transferred to London Strand branch.

Story of Sacrifice

William David Densham (1894 – 1917)

Civilian Life

William David Densham was born in Hull, Yorkshire, on 20 November 1894, the son of William and Jessie Margaret Densham. His father was a bank manager, and William followed him into banking. In May 1911, aged 16, he began an apprenticeship with the National Provincial Bank of England at its Marylebone branch in London. He completed his three-year apprenticeship in April 1914 and remained at Marylebone as a clerk. In May 1915, he transferred to the bank's Strand branch.

Military Life

During the First World War, Densham joined the British Army and served as a Private in the 1st/7th Battalion, Gordon Highlanders, with the service number S/40701. He was killed in action in France on 23 April 1917, aged 22, during the Second Battle of the Scarpe, part of the wider Battle of Arras in the Pas-de-Calais area . On this morning, the 51st (Highland) Division launched an attack against heavily fortified German positions along the chemical works and the village of Roeux, enduring massive machine-gun fire and artillery barrages. Densham was killed on the first day of the battalion's attack against German positions. He was subsequently buried at Ecoivres Military Cemetery at Mont-St-Eloi, France, in grave VI. C. 20. His name is also recorded on the National Provincial Bank of England's First World War memorial, now held by the NatWest Group Archives.

Notes

Gordon Highlanders 1st/7th Bn.

From International Red Cross (on FMP)

D E N	121400
F.s.N.	15476
<u>DENSHAM William David</u>	
Pte. 40701, Gordon Highrs Disparu 23.4.17. (off.) (Aurait été tué). Age: 22.	
<u>Rép:</u> Mrs J. Densham (Mother) The Mount, Preston Rd. Nr Harrow on the Hill, Midd- lesex.	

<u>Tél. fac.</u>	Negatif envoyé 17. 8. 17

From NatWest Archives – URL above

William Densham

Bank: **National Provincial Bank of England**

Place of work: **London Strand branch**

Died: **23 April 1917**

William David Densham was born on 20 November 1894, the son of William Densham, a bank worker, and his wife Jessie Margaret. By 1911, when Densham was 16 years old, his father was manager of National Provincial Bank of England's London High Holborn branch. In May that year, Densham also went to work for the bank, as apprentice at its London Marylebone branch.

Densham completed his three-year apprenticeship in April 1914, and stayed on at Marylebone as a clerk. In May 1915 he transferred to London Strand branch.

During the First World War Densham joined the army, serving as a Private in the Gordon Highlanders. He died in France on 23 April 1917. He was 22 years old.

William Densham is commemorated on a bank war memorial held at [NatWest Group Archives](#).